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15 November 1957

AFCSI-6D INV 24-185

MEMORANDUM

SUBJECT: Unidentified Flying Object in the Vicinity of Kearny, Nebraska

1. On 14 November a meeting was held in the office of the Assistant Chief of Staff, Intelligence, attended by Major JAMES F. BYRNE, of the Executive's office, AFCIN, Captain COPAS, AFCIN-1A1, several members of the 1006th, Mr WES WHALEY, FBI, and the writer. This meeting was held for the purpose of determining whether a violation had been committed which could be investigated by either the OSI or the FBI.

2. The officers of AFCIN stated that NICAP (National Investigative Committee for Aerial Phenomena) whose president is a Mr. KEYHOE, a former Marine Major, is creating national hysteria by their activities in the UFOB field. This organization criticizes the Air Force, saying the Air Force is not competent to investigate UFOB sightings. There are reasons to believe that members of the NICAP were in contact with Mr. [REDACTED], who allegedly sighted the flying object near Kearny. A Miss J. VAN DOREN, a member of NICAP, contacted [REDACTED] telephonically and asked if he would like advance publicity and he, of course, said he would. The activities of NICAP are based on a profit making motive. It is estimated that they have one million members, many of whom are members of the Ground Observer Corps. With dues of \$7.50 each, this organization is "well heeled" financially and it is believed it exploits alleged sightings of UFOBs to increase interest in publications by this organization and, at the present time, a book which is soon to be published by Mr. KEYHOE. This organization has been the source of bad publicity for the Air Force and is costing the Air Force much time and money to run down each sighting. It was the thought of Major BYRNE and his fellow officers that possibly OSI and/or FBI could investigate this organization. Both Mr. WHALEY and the writer expressed the opinion that there was no specific allegation and thus, at the present time, no investigation could be conducted by either OSI or the FBI. 20

3. This memorandum is classified ~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ in accordance with the provisions of paragraph 30c(2)(a), AFR 205-1.

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY [REDACTED]
BY AUTHORITY OF [REDACTED]
BY [REDACTED] 8 DEC 1975
DATE [REDACTED]

Ralph H. Bayer, Major, USAF
Chief, Sabotage Section, S2E Branch
CI DI, OSI (IG)

NOV 21 1957

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OFFICE OF
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1006TH AIR INTELLIGENCE SERVICE SQUADRON
United States Air Force
Ent Air Force Base, Colorado

AISIR

SUBJECT: UFOB, Kearny Nebraska

TO: Commander
1006th Air Intelligence Service Squadron
Ent Air Force Base, Colorado

1. Mr. [REDACTED] who reported this UFOB was interviewed on 6 November 1957 by Lt. Alexander and M/Sgt Pangburn of this organization. The interview was conducted in the Kearny Municipal Building. Prior to the interview Mr. [REDACTED] had been questioned by City and County officials from approximately 1530 on 5 November until 0900 hours, 6 November. At 0900 hours Lt. Alexander and Sgt. Pangburn began the interview with Mr. [REDACTED].

2. The standard ATIC UFOB form was explained to Mr. [REDACTED] in detail and witness completed this form at 1130 hours.

3. At 1245 accompanied by the Kearny police chief, the County Attorney, Lt. Alexander and Sgt. Pangburn, Mr. Schmidt was returned to the scene of the sighting. Mr. [REDACTED] reconstructed the entire sighting and pointed out where the machine had been parked and the direction it flew after take-off.

4. At 1330 Mr. [REDACTED] was returned to the Municipal Building and was interviewed in detail by Lt. Alexander and Sgt. Pangburn. The interview was recorded. Mr. [REDACTED] repeated his entire story of the incident and then was questioned on various details of the sighting by Lt. Alexander and Sgt. Pangburn. The following is a condensed version of Mr. Schmidt's story:

"I turned off the highway to the north to inspect a field of milo (sorghum). I tried to turn back after checking the milo but the road was too narrow. I went further north looking for a spot to turn around; when I came to a gate in the road, I stopped the car and was going to turn around. At this time I noticed a flash of light coming from the river bed in front of me. I decided to go and see what it was. When I got within 60 feet of the river bank, my motor stopped. I didn't think much of this because I had been going over rough roads and thought that perhaps some wires might have jarred loose. I tried the ignition key and stepped on the starter but it wouldn't go. I then noticed this object down in the river bed and at first, thought that it might be a balloon, that had crashed there. I got out of the car and started walking toward this object. When I got about to the bank, I saw it wasn't a balloon but a ship on stilts. At this time a flash of light came out of the ship and seemed to paralyze me and I couldn't walk."

BY [REDACTED] Capt, USAF

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It was approximately 30 feet from the object. Two men came out and asked me if I was armed and then searched me. After the search, I got to where I could move and walk again and I asked them what the ship was and what they were doing. They said they couldn't tell me. I asked if I could see it closer and they said that as long as they couldn't leave for a few minutes, I might as well look at it. We started back to the ship and as we got close a door opened on the left side. When I got into the ship, I noticed that there were four men and two women. They all spoke to me. The one man stayed with me most of the time but they told me that they couldn't tell me anything about the ship. They did tell me not to be alarmed as I wouldn't be harmed. I was in the ship about 25 or 30 minutes. I then heard one gentleman say in German that they were ready for the take-off. They told me I would have to leave; they said goodbye and wished me good luck and I stepped out and the door closed and the ladder came back up into the ship. I stepped back 8 or 10 feet, but when the machine started working I thought there would be a terrific blast, so I stepped back further, almost to the river bank. But there was no blast; it just went straight up into the air and when it got above the trees about 50 feet, it took off in a south-westerly direction. When it got up about 60 feet above the trees, it changed color, turning to a brownish color. Then it just disappeared. As to the time, it must have been shortly after two O'clock when I saw the flash, when I got out of the ship it was about 3:00. It must have taken off about 3:00."

Note: At this point Mr. [REDACTED] appeared to have told all he remembered of the incident and it was necessary to question him for the remainder of the interview.

Q. What language was used during your encounter with these people?

A. The two men who came out to meet me spoke rather broken English, the rest of the crew spoke in the High German language.

Q. Do you understand German?

A. Yes, my parents were from Berlin and as a child I was taught German.

Q. What type of clothing did the people wear?

A. The men wore suits, long ties, and hats. The women wore skirts and light colored blouses.

Q. Can you describe the original flash that you saw?

A. The flash was somewhat like an electrical short, quite brilliant and reddish in color.

Q. Was it bright enough to blind you?

A. No.

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Q. How far were you from the scene of the flash when you saw it?

A. About one half mile.

Q. Why were you in the area at this time?

A. I was inspecting Milo to purchase for my company, if it was dry enough.

Q. Did you know the people that owned this field?

A. No.

Q. How large was the light source that paralyzed you?

A. About as large as a quarter.

Q. What was the color of the light?

A. It appeared to be orange but I can't be sure, it was very fast.

Q. Was the light concentrated on you?

A. Yes, it seemed to be concentrated on me.

Q. Did the light blind you?

A. No.

Q. How long was the light on you?

A. About three seconds.

Q. Can you describe the men who came out to meet you?

A. They were about 5'4" tall and had hats, long ties and business suits, they were quite dark complexioned.

Q. How old were they?

A. About 45 or 50 years old.

Q. Did you hear the people talking while you were in the machine?

A. Yes, they were talking about the machine in German.

Q. Did you ask what the machine was powered by?

A. Yes, but they said they couldn't tell me.

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Q. Did they prevent you from looking at the equipment?

A. No, but they tried to keep me from the end of the machine where the girls were working.

Q. Do you recall the appearance of the dials or instruments?

A. Yes, some looked like kitchen clocks only had more fingers on them. Some were like a long fluorescent lights.

Q. Did you see any markings on the dials?

A. No, but they did have numbers on them - both Roman numerals and ordinary numbers.

Q. What were the occupants doing during the time you were in the machine?

A. The one man was with me all the time. The others were working on the wiring in the machine.

Q. Will you describe the conveyor belt in the machine?

A. It was the full length of the room which was about 40 feet long. They would get on this conveyor and power would seem to pull them across. They didn't have to move their feet at all. It went about the speed a man would walk and could be used in either direction. It seemed to move them by some magnetic force.

Q. What type lighting was used in the machine?

A. I couldn't see any, but it was as light as in this room.

Q. What was the floor made of?

A. It looked as if it was heavy glass or aluminum. You could look right through it from the inside out.

Q. Were the walls of the same material as the floor?

A. Yes, you could see out in all directions.

Q. Were the instruments transparent too?

A. No, they seemed to be of material similar to aluminum.

Q. Did you notice the type of support this machine had?

A. Yes, it had four hydraulic rams, I would say.

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Q. How did you know they were hydraulic rams?

A. Well, where it sat on the ground it appeared to have a pad of rubber and above it was shiny metal that looked as if it might be hydraulic.

Q. How long did you estimate the rams to be?

A. About three feet.

Q. How large a diameter?

A. About three inches I would say.

Q. Was there any other support?

A. No.

Q. When the machine took off how fast do you think it rose?

A. I couldn't say but the first ten feet or so it was quite slow then picked up speed.

Q. How high was the machine when it stopped rising and took off?

A. I would say about 150 feet.

Q. Did the object hover when it got to this height?

A. No, it took right off in a southwesterly direction.

Q. What distance do you estimate the sound of the machine could be heard?

A. It seemed to me that on a quiet day it could be heard for quite a distance. There was no exhaust, just a humming sound like large fans would make.

This concludes the questioning by Lt. Alexander. Sgt. Pangburn's questions follows:

Q. Are you interested in Aircraft and do you know the principles of aerial flight?

A. I have flown as a passenger only.

Q. How do you think the machine got its lift?

A. I really don't know. I was looking for something to come out below it when it took off but nothing came out.

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Q. Did you see any movable surfaces on the outside of the machine?

A. No nothing. It appeared to be a sealed unit.

Q. During your conversation with these people did they refer to this by a name.

A. No.

Q. You have mentioned that this appeared to be a sealed unit and that you could see out on all sides and the bottom. Is this correct?

A. Yes, except that you couldn't see out on the ends of the machine.

Q. While you were in the machine did you notice or hear any machinery running?

A. No I did not.

Q. For the record will you describe the configuration of the entire machine?

A. It was shaped like one half of a hot dog bun, with a flat bottom.

Q. Did you see any evidence of bolts, nuts or welds inside the ship?

A. No, it looked as if it were molded with no seams.

Q. You said there was no blast from the fans, that there was a fan in front and in back. Did you see both fans?

A. No, I only saw the front fan but the noise indicated that there was a fan in each end.

Q. Did the weeds move under the machine when it took off?

A. No.

Q. Can you tell me why the weeds under the machine were not broken by the body of the machine which must have been setting on them. It seemed most of the weeds were about four or five feet high.

A. No, I can't. The machine only had about three feet clearance from the ground.

Q. Did you see seat belts on any of the chairs in the machine?

A. No.

Q. Will you describe the forward and rear compartments of the machine?

A. Both ends appeared to have a wall that was made of some sort of metal.

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Q. Could you see through this metal?

A. No, it was different than the sides and bottom of the machine.

Q. Would this be the area that housed the fans you mentioned?

A. Yes it is.

Q. How long were the end compartments that housed the fans?

A. I would say about 20 to 25 feet long.

Q. When you saw the one fan from the outside, did it look as if the fan occupied all of the space?

A. No, I don't believe so, it looked as if the fan sat in a hole that was about 12 feet around.

Q. Did the tips of the fan appear to be close to the opening. By that I mean how much clearance would you estimate the fan had from the housing?

A. It appeared to have just enough space around it to clear the sides.

Q. Did you see any method that could be used to enter the compartment that housed the fans?

A. No, I did not.

Q. You mean that the wall on the inside of the ship was solid and that there were no openings to reach this compartment from the outside?

A. Yes.

Q. You mentioned the instruments earlier, could you tell me if you noticed any part of the instrument sticking out behind the dials?

A. No, I looked and there were only wires running to the back of the instrument dials.

Q. Where did these wires go to from the instruments?

A. Well I noticed that they seemed to go into some sort of a tube and ran up toward the front of the machine.

Q. Did they actually go into the front compartment of the machine?

A. Yes, they seemed to.

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Q. Did you notice a similar tube running to the back of the machine?

A. No, I didn't see any.

Q. Did you touch the machine?

A. Yes, I felt the outside of the machine.

Q. What did it feel like?

A. It felt like highly polished metal.

Q. Could you see through the machine from the outside?

A. No, it was completely blank, you could only see out from the inside.

Q. Was the machine sharply defined?

A. Yes.

This concluded the questioning of Mr. ██████.

5. The physical evidence that was mentioned in various press releases was checked with the following results:

a. The oil spot found near the scene of the supposed landing had fresh oil on the leaves and grass. A good sample of this oil was obtained and has been sent to the University of Nebraska for analysis. One oil can was found near the scene. It was a Veedel 10-30 weight oil can that had been opened with an ordinary beer can opener. A search of Mr. ██████'s car revealed that another full can of Veedel 10-30 weight oil was in the trunk of the car. The opener found in the car had fresh oil on it and had a small nick on one side of the cutting edge. This nick corresponded to the hole that was found in the can at the scene of the reported landing. It would appear that the oil was poured on the ground by Mr. ██████. Definite proof should be available to this organization in the next several days.

b. A circular track was found at the scene of the reported landing that Mr. ██████ felt was caused by one of the landing gears on the machine. By the time Lt. Alexander and Sgt. Pangburn arrived at the scene, all tracks had been obliterated by members of the press and visitors to the scene. The top of a tin can was found near the spot that the track supposedly had been seen. It could have been used to make an impression resembling that found by Mr. ██████.

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c. A farmer who had been hauling beets approximately one mile from the scene at the same time Mr. [REDACTED] had his electrical failure, also had his truck stall at the same approximate time. An investigation revealed that a mechanic had been called from Kearney to fix the farmer's truck. The mechanic was interviewed and he stated that the distributor rotor on the farmer's truck had been changed the day before this incident, and when changing the rotor one small piece of the old one had not been removed from the housing. As a result the piece wedged in between the points and caused the electrical failure.

6. The interview was concluded at approximately 1700 hours on 6 November 1957. Two qualified psychiatrists interviewed Mr. [REDACTED] for a period of two hours. Their findings indicated that Mr. [REDACTED] was definitely a mental case and possibly could have suicidal tendencies. They also stated that with his particular mental condition, he would undoubtedly enjoy the publicity he was receiving from this incident. A hearing of the county health board was held at 2000 hours that evening and Mr. [REDACTED] was formally committed to the state hospital for the mentally ill in Hastings, Nebraska.

7. In view of the findings of the investigators and the final medical action taken on Mr. [REDACTED] it is believed that this sighting was strictly a hallucination of the part of the witness and feel that no further action is warranted. It is also the opinion of the investigators that Mr. [REDACTED] firmly believed that he had actually seen this apparatus and had visited with its occupants.

1st/Lt. Gregory Alexander
Investigator

M/Sgt William Pangburn
Investigator

NOV 21 1957

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UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
INSPECTOR GENERAL

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RECORD OF ACTION TAKEN
UPON RECEIPT OF INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION

DATE OF REPORT S 5 Nov 57

TIME RECEIVED 2350 hrs

INCOMING FROM Mr. Gilbert Levy

ACTION AGENCY AFCIN

AGENCY INFORMED AND WHEN

INDIVIDUAL NOTIFIED AND WHEN

FBI

S/A Mooney 0010 hrs, 6 Nov

AFCIN Indications Center

Maj. Williams, C. J. 0025, 6 Nov

USAF Command POST

Maj. Burns 0035, 6 Nov

REMARKS: Mr. LEVY stated that he had just received the following information telephonically from Col. KENNETH KING, District Commander, DO#13: The Omaha Office of the FBI had reported to Col KING that at 1600 hrs, 5 Nov, Mr. [REDACTED] reported that he had seen a flash in the sky near the Platte river, in the vicinity of Kearney, Nebraska. Informant said he proceeded in his vehicle in direction of the flash and soon spotted a large plastic balloon on the ground near the river. When he approached within about 50 yards of the object the motor on his vehicle stopped for no apparent reason. Two men jumped out of the balloon and directed a ray-gun at [REDACTED], which paralyzed him. The men came over to him and he was able to walk when they turned off the ray. (continued on reverse side)

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLING

BY AUTHORITY OF THE SECRETARY OF DEFENSE

BY ARTHUR KENZEL, Capt, USAF

RECEIVED

3 DEC 1975

DATE

(SIGNATURE)

FRED B. BROWN

Major USAF

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NOT RECORDED

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_____ accompanied the two men to the balloon, described as 100' long, 30' wide and 12' high, and he went inside. From inside the balloon he could see outside through the walls just as though they were not there. Two women were seated at the control panel. They talked German. Two other men were inside the balloon. _____ was informed by the visitors that they intended him no harm and that he would hear more about them later. With that, he left the Balloon and it immediately rose 100' vertically and disappeared. A tripod was used as a landing gear, according to _____

According to the FBI report, a Nebraska police official had determined that _____ was an employee of Valu-Pac, Inc., of Brawley, Calif., a seed company. His home was listed as Bakersfield, California. The police official said he had been informed by Bakersfield police that _____ was a reliable individual. Oil marks, tire marks and pieces possibly from a tripod were found at the alleged scene.

NOTE: The information furnished by Mr. _____ was not as complete as furnished above, but additional details were obtained from Agent MOONEY, FBI, when I contacted him.

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(AFR 190-16)

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Air Force Set To Study 3 of 46 'Objects'

Associated Press
3 The North American Air Defense Command at Colorado Springs, Colo., reported yesterday it had received 46 reports of unidentified objects from throughout the Nation but only three, including one from Kearney, Neb., deserved further study.

Capt. Andy Beasley, public information officer, said two Air Force investigators were sent to Kearney after a Californian, R. O. Schmidt, told of sighting a cigar-shaped object on a Nebraska prairie and chatting with four men and two women in it.

Beasley said the command had not yet decided whether to assign inspectors to the two other reported sightings. He did not say where these reports came from.

Florida Sightings

A dazzling fiery object flashed across southern skies an hour before sunup yesterday and some observers reported it zoomed close to them at treetop level. Reports of sightings came from Albany, Ga., to Miami. The majority described the brilliantly lighted thing as blue or green.

At Tallahassee, Fla., Florida State University department of meteorology professor said that from descriptions of the objects it appeared to be a meteor which came unusually close to the earth.

N. E. Lesner, the professor, said the meteors appeared to give off a bluish green light, particularly at night.

The navigator of the Coast Guard cutter, Sebago, estimated that a flying object sighted over the Gulf of Mexico Tuesday had a speed of between 1000 and 13300 miles per hour.

Time Figured

Lt. (jg) Donald Shaffer of Greensburg, Pa., said he based the estimate on elapsed time and distance traveled between the first and second sightings on the cutter's radar screen.

The cutter refueled at the Pensacola Naval Air Station dock during the morning yesterday and then departed for its home port at Mobile, Ala.

Ensign Wayne Shockley of Redlands, Calif., who was officer of the deck when the object was sighted, and radarman James Moore, Carlton, Tex., left the ship today to New York to appear today on a national television program.

Today.

Crewmen said they have not yet been questioned by Air Force investigators.

The Air Force said Tuesday its radar network of the Air Defense Command had been alerted to watch for the object.

Mr. Levy *4/8*
Mr. Tolson *✓*
Mr. Sullivan *✓*
Mr. Boardman *✓*
Mr. Nichols *✓*
Mr. Belmont *✓*
Mr. Mohr *✓*
Mr. DeLoach *✓*
Mr. Casper *✓*
Mr. Callahan *✓*
Mr. Conrad *✓*
Mr. Felt *✓*
Mr. Gale *✓*
Mr. Rosen *✓*
Mr. Sullivan *✓*
Mr. Tavel *✓*
Mr. Trotter *✓*
Tele. Room *✓*
Mr. Holloman *✓*
Miss Gandy *✓*

(THE WASHINGTON POST AND
TIMES HERALD)

7 Nov 1957, PAGE 3
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HQ CSI USAF File Nr. _____

A&D Br _____

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NOV 11 1957
INVESTIGATIONS
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7/11/57

Coast to Coast

Rash of 'Flying Saucer' Reports Floods U. S.

Several persons reported seeing a "red ball" hovering over the Atomic Energy Commission's Savannah River plant near Augusta, Ga., last night.

7-0416-1?
14-0-666?
There was an unofficial report that Air Force personnel at nearby Aiken, S. C., spotted the object on radar and issued an alert.

The object appeared to be a "constant red light," according to Augusta Chronicle executive editor Louis Harris, who saw the object from the downtown newspaper building. "It could have been a tiny red light a short distance away or a gigantic thing at a great distance," he said.

One witness, J. T. James, said he saw the object on two occasions from his home near Aiken. It was cigar-shaped, he said, and would alternate from bright to amber and occasionally got out altogether.

Elsewhere, strange "saucer" sightings were reported.

NEBRASKA

At Kearney, Neb., authorities held a "heart-to-heart" talk with Reinhold O. Schmidt, a salesman, later discovered to be an ex-convict, who said he talked to four men and two women in a transport space ship which had landed. He said the space people spoke in English and German.

Police roped off the area where the "whatnik" allegedly landed and examined various impressions and oil stains on the ground.

At Long Beach, Calif., three Air Force weather observers, one of them the commanding officer of the spotting unit, late yesterday reported sighting six unidentified, saucer-shaped flying objects over Long Beach Air Force base.

The Coast Guard reported picking up an unidentified flying object on radar over the Gulf of Mexico south of New Orleans. A Coast Guard commander said the object paused over the cutter Sebago in the Gulf and was on the radar scope for about 27 minutes.

WHITE SANDS

Military authorities apparently gave credence to a report by an electronics engineer who said he saw an object which made car engines stall near the White Sands proving grounds.

Col. John McCurdy, Air Force public relations officer at White Sands, said the engineer, James Stokes, 42, will be given a thorough medical examination and a radiation count test. Col. McCurdy said he was "personally satisfied" with Mr. Stokes' report.

A Civil Service worker at Lackland Air Force Base in San Antonio, Tex., said he saw an egg-shaped object land in a ravine about 200 yards from him as he drove near the city. He said his car engine and lights went off, and the object took off in a few minutes, enabling him to drive away.

At about the same time, the Ground Observer Corps at Midland, Tex., said it saw a large, red object and picked up unintelligible conversation on a sound detector. (U)

(WASHINGTON DAILY NEWS)

6 Nov 1957, PAGE 7
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